

1.3

Showing interest

Business Builder
Teacher Resource Series

Worksheet

A Practise these mini-dialogues.

Student A

- 1 I've just come back from France.
- 2 Mary went into hospital again.
- 3 We're thinking about getting a bigger flat.
- 4 Michael's looking for a new job.

Student B

- ▶ Have you? France! Where did you go?
- ▶ Again? What a pity. I must go and visit her.
- ▶ Are you? Where are you moving to?
- ▶ Mhm. I'm not surprised.

Write examples of the techniques used by Student B to show interest.

Echo questions (repeating the auxiliary verb): *Have you?*

Echo questions: *France!*

Wh- questions: *Where did you go?*

Making a personal response: *What a pity.*

B The table below shows some techniques for showing interest.

Showing attention	Right. Sure. Yes. Yeah. Yuh. Mhm. Uhuh.
Echo questions	Did you? Are they? Was it?
Echo words	Five hundred? Six months? All over the world?
Wh- questions	So what happened? Why was that, then? How did you feel?
Personal response	1 _____ Really? That sounds interesting. 2 _____ Really! Fantastic! Great! 3 _____ Exactly. Of course. Sure. 4 _____ How awful. What a pity. Poor you. 5 _____ No! That's strange! Good heavens! 6 _____ Mhm. I'm not surprised.

Complete the table by writing one of these words in each space 1–6.

interest surprise no surprise pleasure agreement sympathy

C Write a response to these comments. Use ideas from section B and your own ideas.

Comment	Response
1 I saw Irina yesterday.	_____
2 I'm thinking about going to Brazil for my holidays.	_____
3 I was waiting all morning for the repair man.	_____
4 I went to see that new film last night.	_____

D Work with a new partner.

Student A Tell a story about something that happened to you recently.

Student B Show interest.